

VISUAL IDENTITY & DESIGN SYSTEM

Brand Style Guide

WorkforceAP · Version 1.0 · March 2026

NAVIGATION

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01

Brand Identity

Mission, positioning, and personality.

Mission

WorkforceAP is the operating system for workforce development — connecting underserved adults, the organizations that serve them, and the employers that need them, in one verified closed loop.

Brand Personality

Trait	Definition
Grounded	Show outcomes, not promises.
Direct	Plain language. No jargon.
Warm	This is someone's livelihood.
Ambitious	Infrastructure, not a charity.
Inclusive	No age gate. No degree. No exclusion.

02

Color System

WCAG AA compliant. Token-based. Light and dark mode aware.

Primary Palette

			
Crimson (Accent)	Gold	Near Black	White
#AD2C4D	#FFBB00	#121416	#FFFFFF
CTAs, links, all accent uses	Dark bg only — fails on light	Hero bg, dark surfaces	Text on dark, light surfaces

Supporting Palette

			
Accent Dark	Blue	Green	On Surface Var.
#8B1F38	#2B7BB9	#4A9B4F	#584144
Hover on Crimson	Links, info states	Success, positive metrics	Secondary text, labels

✓ DO	Use Crimson (#AD2C4D) as the sole CTA color.
✓ DO	Use Gold on dark backgrounds only — fails WCAG on light.
✓ DO	Use var() CSS tokens — never hardcode hex values.
✗ DON'T	Gold on white/light gray — 1.7:1 contrast, fails WCAG.
✗ DON'T	var(--color-white) for hero text — remaps to near-black in dark mode.

03

Typography

Inter is our single typeface. Hierarchy through weight and size.

Display / H1

40px · 800 · -0.03em

Empowering People. Advancing Futures.

H2

32px · 700 · -0.02em

Industry-Recognized Certifications

H3

24px · 700

Digital Literacy Program

H4

20px · 700

Program Requirements

Body

16px · 400 · 1.6lh

Free career training for adults at every stage of their journey.

Small

14px · 400

Duration: 3–6 months · Cost to member: \$0

04

Spacing & Layout

8px base grid. Consistent scale. No arbitrary values.

Spacing Scale

Token	Value	Usage
--space-1	4px	Icon gaps, tight badge padding
--space-2	8px	Compact element padding
--space-4	16px	Standard gap, button padding
--space-6	24px	Card padding, element gaps
--space-8	32px	Section element spacing
--space-12	48px	Mobile section padding
--space-16	64px	Desktop section padding
--space-24	96px	Hero and major section padding

Border Radius

Token	Value	Usage
--radius-sm	4px	Tags, badges
--radius-md	8px	Buttons, inputs
--radius-lg	12px	Cards, dropdowns
--radius-xl	16px	Modals, prominent containers
--radius-full	50px	Pills, avatars

05

Buttons & CTAs

One primary action per view. Specific copy. Clear hierarchy.

CTA Copy Rules

✓ Write This	✗ Not This	Principle
Apply for Free	Learn More	Specific + zero-cost signal
Start My Application	Click Here	Personal + action verb
Compare Programs	Submit	Describes what happens next
Download Salary Guide	Get Started Today!	No fake urgency
Partner With Us	Explore Opportunities	Clear intent

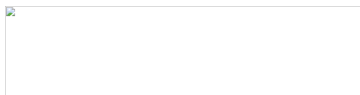
06

Logo Usage

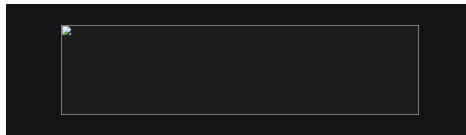
Never stretched. Never recolored. Always with clear space.

Rule	Standard
Clear Space	Minimum 1× height of "W" letterform on all sides
Minimum Size	120px wide (digital) / 1 inch (print)
On Light Backgrounds	Full color — crimson icon, dark wordmark
On Dark / Photo Backgrounds	White version only
On Accent (crimson)	White version only
Never	Stretch, skew, recolor, add gradient/shadow, or crop below 120px

Logo Variants



On white / light backgrounds



On dark / photo backgrounds



On accent (crimson) backgrounds

07

Voice & Copy

Plain. Direct. Human. Specific. Never corporate speak.

✓ Direct "Apply now. We respond within 3–5 business days."	✗ Corporate "We'd love to connect on your exciting journey forward!"
✓ Specific "CompTIA A+, IBM AI Professional, \$62K–\$88K starting."	✗ Vague "Industry-recognized certs in high-demand fields."
✓ Inclusive "For adults at any stage of their career."	✗ Exclusive "For recent grads and young professionals."
✓ Free "\$0 cost to members."	✗ Hedged "Complimentary training (terms apply)."

Terminology

Use This	Not This	Reason
Member	Student / User / Candidate	We serve adults in a community, not students.
Counselor	Advisor / Coach / Mentor	Specific role with defined responsibilities.
Free / \$0	No-cost / Complimentary	Say it plainly. Asterisks create distrust.
WorkforceAP	WAP / Workforce AP	One word, camel case. Always.
CompTIA A+	"a certification"	Always use full official certification name.

08

Quick Reference

All rules. One page.

Category	Rule
Primary CTA	#AD2C4D Crimson — always, one per screen
Gold	Dark backgrounds only. Never on white/light (fails WCAG)
Hero Text	Use #fff directly on dark overlays — NOT var(--color-white)
Font	Inter only. Body 16px/1.6lh. Headings Bold 700
Spacing	8px grid. CSS tokens only — no arbitrary values
Contrast	4.5:1 body, 3:1 large text/UI components (WCAG AA)
Radius	Buttons: 8px · Cards: 12px · Modals: 16px
Mobile	<640px: single column, 44px touch targets, bottom nav
Logo	1× "W" height clear space. Min 120px. Never below 120px.
CTA Copy	"Apply for Free" > "Learn More" — specific + active voice
Dark Mode	Use var() tokens — never hardcode hex in components
Terminology	"Member" not "student". "WorkforceAP" not "WAP"

Design system: [workforceap-beta/css/main.css](#) · Questions: info@workforceap.org